

Digital Services Act

Transparency Report for Stores

February 2025

Introduction

This report includes content moderation data and information for user content from the Ratings & Reviews service that consumers use to share feedback on store products and Apps & Games content published by business customers on the following stores:

- Microsoft Store on Windows (MSOW)
- Microsoft.com (apps.microsoft.com)
- Microsoft Store on Xbox console (MSOX)
- Xbox app on PC (Garrison)
- Xbox.com

This DSA Transparency Report is responsive to the obligations under DSA Article 15(1), Article 24(1), and Article 42(2)-(3). This Report provides information regarding the following topics as they pertain to the European Union:

- Updates to the Terms of Service
- Content Moderation at Microsoft's Initiative
- Content Moderation & Automated Systems
- Content Moderation following a User Report
- Content Moderation Appeals
- Government Requests
- Out of Court Settlement Body Disputes

Updates to the Terms of Service

In our most recent Microsoft Store on Windows Policy updates ([7.18](#)) we have added a new policy under Account Types, specifically [10.14](#), that added language to align with the EU

DSA business verification and customer contact information that is required for company accounts.

“Company accounts must be used for organizations, businesses, and any person acting in relation to their trade or profession. Individual accounts are usually appropriate for a single developer working on their own. A company account is required if your product requires financial information for primary functionality (see Policy 10.8.3) or if a reasonable consumer would interpret your application or publisher name to be that of a business entity.

If your developer account is a Company account type, you must provide identification or business verification information during account creation, and you must include customer support contact information that will be displayed on your product’s Product Detail Page (PDP) in certain regions. This information is required to be accurate and current.

For more information go to our account-types page [here](#).”

Content Moderation at Microsoft’s Initiative

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Article 15(1)(c). This section reports data regarding content moderation of Ratings & Reviews and Apps & Games engaged in on its own initiative, absent a user report.

Ratings & Reviews on Microsoft Stores

The content moderation that is performed by Microsoft Stores on Ratings & Reviews at its own initiative includes automated content detection for spam and automated profanity redaction. Specific details on the automated processes are included in the ‘Content Moderation & Automated Systems’ section.

Microsoft Stores also monitors user accounts and activity based on moderation actions taken on the content created by the user. This involves a monthly review of user accounts where 5 or more reviews were removed in the previous month for policy violations. Based on Microsoft policy and Terms of Use (ToU) actions may be taken on those accounts.

Apps and Games on Microsoft Stores

Microsoft has an extensive automated system in place for scanning apps and games submitted through our portal for sale on the Microsoft Store. These scans look for a wide variety of behavior in compliance with [Microsoft Store Policy](#) including malware, basic functionality, offensive content, and much more. If those scans find any issues the submission is routed to highly trained human moderators for further review.

All of these activities take place before the application and updates are published to the store. Therefore, we do not have any additional automated scanning of content already in the Store, with the exception of content hosted outside of Microsoft (a small portion of apps), which undergoes a “continuous scanning” approach looking for malware.

Additionally, we have a team of human reviewers that conduct a variety of audits of published content for Microsoft Store Policy compliance directed by a variety of factors such as observed trends or business needs. We also receive reports from internal and external sources which we investigate for Microsoft Store Policy compliance.

For already published products, we moderate content using several types of restrictions. All of these restrictions can be removed at any time when the issue is resolved. In some cases, depending on the nature and severity of the issue, Microsoft may choose to not ever remove the restriction. The types of available application restrictions are:

- **Suppress** – The product is not searchable or browsable in the Store but is able to be updated by the developer to make changes to correct any issues. This is typically a temporary state.
- **Take Down** – In addition to the above, the product is not able to be re-installed by users and the developer cannot update the product. This is typically permanent but can be adjusted based on reconsideration or appeal.

Additionally, in rare cases of persistent infringement or egregious behavior, we will add a restriction at the account level which removes access to the account for the developer and also removes products in the account from the store.

Microsoft utilizes an external Managed Service for moderating content. The employees of the service are trained by a lead agent through an extensive and ongoing training program. That lead agent is in turn trained by Microsoft through a collaborative effort which includes maintaining elaborate and living policy interpretation guidance, analysis of moderation effectiveness data, policy change management, spot tests & audits, feedback & appeals, and regular review. The vendor uses a month’s long initial training & supervision program, followed by weekly update meetings, emergency policy and process revisions as needed, Teams chat channels for questions and nuanced cases, and individualized retraining as needed. This is an always ongoing program to keep agents as sharp as possible.

Product Data, respectively: MS Store on Windows | Microsoft.com Website Store | PC Games Store

Policy Violation	Number of measures taken at the provider's own initiative			Number of measures taken after detection with solely automated means			Visibility restriction Removal		
Consumer Information	828	828	828	828	828	828	828	828	828
Illegal or Harmful Speech	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Nonconsensual Behavior	16	16	16	16	16	16	16	16	16
Scope of Platform Services	2,275	2,275	2,275	2,275	2,275	2,275	2,275	2,275	2,275

Product Data, respectively: Xbox Console Store | Xbox.com Website Store

Part 2 of 2

Policy Violation	Number of measures taken at the provider's own initiative		Number of measures taken after detection with solely automated means		Visibility restriction Removal	
Consumer Information	828	828	828	828	828	828
Illegal or Harmful Speech	1	1	1	1	1	1
Nonconsensual Behaviour	16	16	16	16	16	16
Scope of Platform Services	2,275	2,275	2,275	2,275	2,275	2,275

Account Level Actions for Microsoft Stores

See the Xbox Safety section for overall data on account level actions. Note: actions based solely on Ratings & Reviews are not available.

Content Moderation & Automated Systems

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Articles 15(1)(e) and 42(2)(c).

Ratings & Reviews on Microsoft Stores

Automated spam detection is used to identify and remove “spam” or fraudulent content that violates Microsoft policy and/or Terms of Use (ToU). The automated detection method is asynchronous, occurring within 24 hours of ratings & reviews being created. This automated process uses a variety of criteria to evaluate if the source of the rating & review or the content itself is “spam”. The criteria includes, but is not limited to, user account reputation details, the review content, IP address details, and different types of suspicious

activity. If the rating only or rating with review is determined to meet the above criteria then it is automatically removed from public viewing. The engineering team that owns the automated spam detection process is regularly updating criteria to meet best in practice standards.

Automated profanity redaction is used to identify and remove inappropriate terms that violate Microsoft policy and/or Terms of Use (ToU). This automated process uses a central service to scan text synchronously to determine the language and then compare text to known inappropriate words for the detected language. When the scan detects an inappropriate word in the detected language, it replaces the word with asterisks. This scan and replacement take place after the user submits their review content (newly created or when they edit their existing review) before it is published publicly.

Apps and Games on Microsoft Stores

After the initial publishing of apps and games, Microsoft does not employ ongoing automated content moderation. If applications are updated by their developer, those updates will be reviewed prior to being published.

	MS Store on Windows	Microsoft .com Website Store	PC Games Store	Xbox Console Store	Xbox.co m Website Store
Number of measures not taken by automated means	3,120	3,120	3,120	3,120	3,120

Content Moderation following a User Report

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Articles 15(1)(b)-(c) and 41(2)(a)-(b).

Ratings & Reviews on Microsoft Stores

Report a concern for ratings & reviews allows all users (authenticated or anonymous) to report an individual review containing illegal content and/or violating Microsoft policy. The ability to report is available on product detail pages where Ratings & Reviews are present. Users click on the flag icon next to a review and are entered into the Report a Concern flow.

[EU-DSA- Report a concern- Consumer Content_V1.0.vsdX \(sharepoint.com\)](#)

Apps and Games on Microsoft Stores

The Report A Concern function in Microsoft stores allows users to report illegal content or that which violates Microsoft Store Policies. They do this by clicking on the “Report this product...” links found on the product description page and following through on the subsequent form.

Those complaints are received and acknowledged by the system and then reviewed by the content moderation team for compliance with the law and Microsoft Store Policy.

Appropriate action is taken utilizing the same restrictions mentioned above when needed. When action is taken, the developer and the complaining user are notified by the system.

Product Data: Xbox Console Store

Policy Violation	Number of notices received	Number of specific items of information included in the total number of notices	Median time to take action
IP Infringements	1	2	171.0

Content Moderation Appeals

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Article 15(1)(d)

Ratings & Reviews on Microsoft Stores

Appeals related to content that is reported using Report-a-Concern or Government Orders/Requests are handled by a centralized Digital Trust and Safety process. Initially, support agents review appeals and may approve them if appropriate. Appeals can be escalated to Microsoft leadership or the Microsoft Store Policy Board for further consideration if needed. Transparency is maintained by updating and posting yearly statistics on appeals on the Store Policy website.

Apps and Games on Microsoft Stores

Microsoft provides an appeals process allowing ISV to reach out via email to the ReportApp@microsoft.com team, the primary support team for the certification process. Appeals are initially considered by support agents, who can approve the appeal and take appropriate corrective action. Appeals can also be escalated by the agent or by request of the ISV to Microsoft leadership for further consideration. Then the final available step for

escalation is the Microsoft Store Policy Board, which may consider final appeals as a part of their regular meetings.

Statistics on appeals in our Store process are updated yearly and [posted](#) on the Store Policy website. 829 appeals were considered between July 2023 and July 2024.

Government Requests

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Article 15(1)(a)

Ratings & Reviews on Microsoft Stores

Government Orders/Requests are received and actioned through a centralized Digital Trust and Safety process. Once the legality of the order has been confirmed, enforcement action is taken and, where appropriate, notifications to the content owner are sent. This process is designed to ensure consistency, transparency and legal compliance.

No EU government orders were received.

Apps and Games on Microsoft Stores

Government inquiries are also received and processed by the ReportApp@microsoft.com team. Report App monitors the GovReport@microsoft.com email alias but reports often come through a variety of Microsoft sources known to government officials. Once routed to the team, the requests are validated and appropriately addressed.

No EU government orders were received.

Out of Court Settlement Body Disputes

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Article 24(1)(a).

Microsoft Stores did not receive notice of any disputes submitted to an out-of-court dispute settlement bodies during the reporting period.